26.	Fennel 	Sombu	Bulb, foliage and seeds of anise were used	Used as flavouring agent. Similar to anise. Prevents cardiac problems.
27.	Vanilla 	Vanilla beans	Seeds of vanillin plant	Used as flavouring agent. Cures stomach ailments.
28.	Curry leaf 	karuvepillai	leaves	Used as flavouring agent and garnishing agent.

Garam masala used in all curry preparations in India is a mixture of eight spices- cloves, cinnamon, black pepper, mace, bay leaf, cardamom, cumin, coriander seeds

6.2 Food additives

According to Food Protection Committee of the Food & Nutrition Board, Food additives may be defined as "A substance or mixture of substances, other than a basic food stuff, which is present in a food as a result of any aspect of food production, processing, storage or packaging". The term does not include chance contaminants.

Food additives are substances which are added to food which either improve the flavour, texture, colour, chemical preservatives ,taste, appearance or function as processing aid.

6.2.1 Need for food additives

- It provides protection against food spoilage during storage, transportation, distribution and processing.
- It is included in the preparation of convenience foods like jams and jellies.
- To fortify or enrich the foods.
- It is used to add colour, flavour, firmness and retards or hastens chemical reaction in food.
- To maintain nutritional quality of food.
- Used as a preservative and colouring agent.

6.2.2 Classification of food additives

The food additives can be classified as following:

- Preservatives
- Colouring agents
- Anti oxidants
- Artificial sweeteners

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